

Everyone says take time off when you are burned out.

Most leaders do. They disconnect, they rest, they come back with good intentions. And then, within three or four weeks, they are back in the same exhaustion they left.

The break is not what failed them. They came back to the same meeting load, the same low-priority requests absorbing their time, the same structure that had been quietly draining them for months. None of that changed while they were gone.

Burnout is not primarily a rest problem. **When the work you do every day does not connect to any sense of forward movement, you drain faster than any vacation can refill.** Rest pauses the symptoms. Only changing the structure addresses the source.

If you came back from time off and already feel the weight again, what does that tell you about what you returned to?

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